Welcome to Windows 98

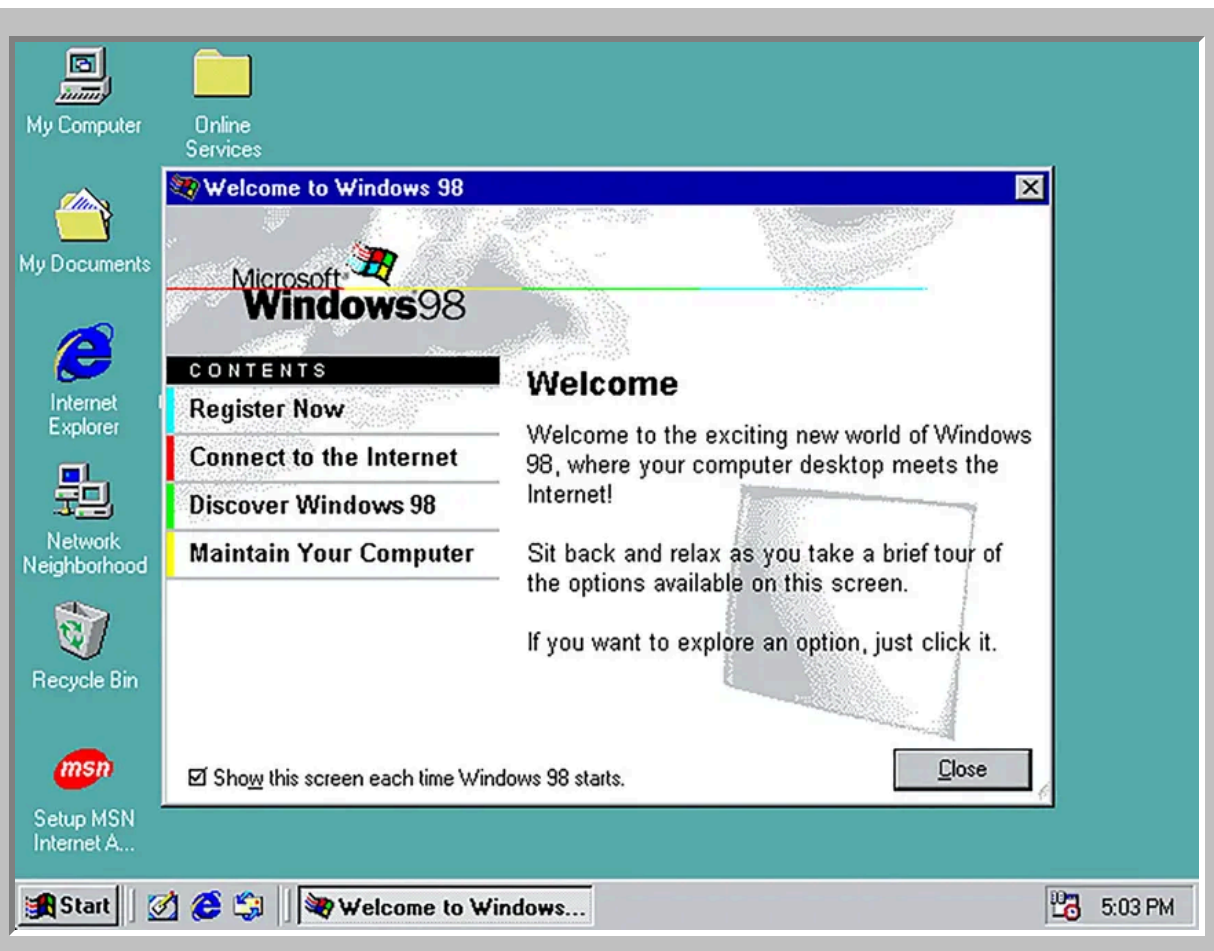
GANDHI HACKATHON

THE ABANDONED COMPUTER

OpenLake × Meraz

Indian Institute of Technology Bhilai

1st November 2026



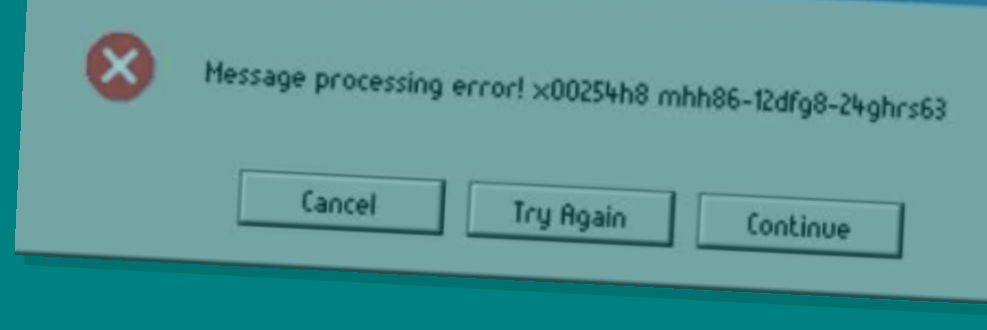
Unknown error

Close

PROBLEM STATEMENT · Read all 7 pages before you start building.

SECTION 01

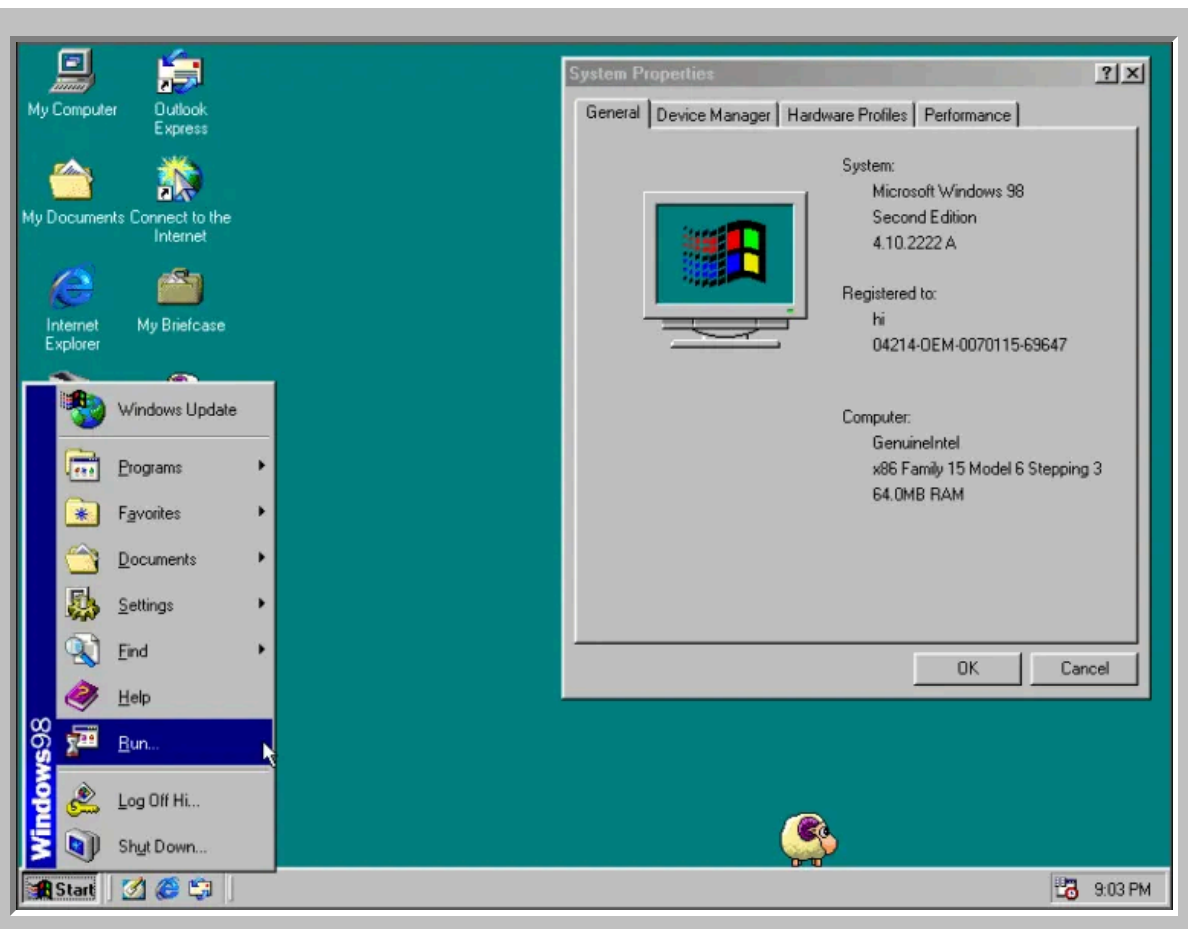
The Premise



System Properties

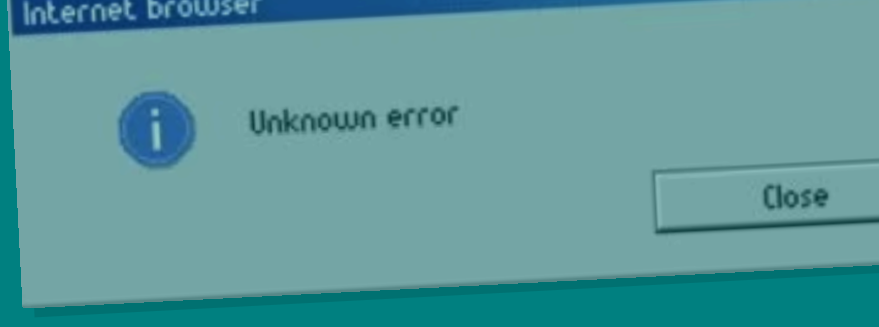
You have discovered an **abandoned computer running Windows 98**.

Your task is to bring this forgotten machine back to life by recreating its entire digital environment as a **website or desktop application**.



Build an interactive Windows 98 replica that captures the **look, feel and experience** of using a computer from that era.

From the wallpaper and icons to the applications, files, folders and browser — every detail should reflect the computing environment of the **late 1990s and early 2000s**.



SECTION 02

What You Can Build

You have complete creative freedom. These are options, not requirements.

1 **Desktop Environment**
The classic desktop, icons, taskbar, Start menu and window management

2 **Applications**
Word, Paint, Notepad, Calculator, Internet Explorer, File Explorer

3 **Internet Experience**
Period websites, search engines, email clients and browser interfaces

4 **Files & Folders**
Realistic documents, photographs, games and other files from the period

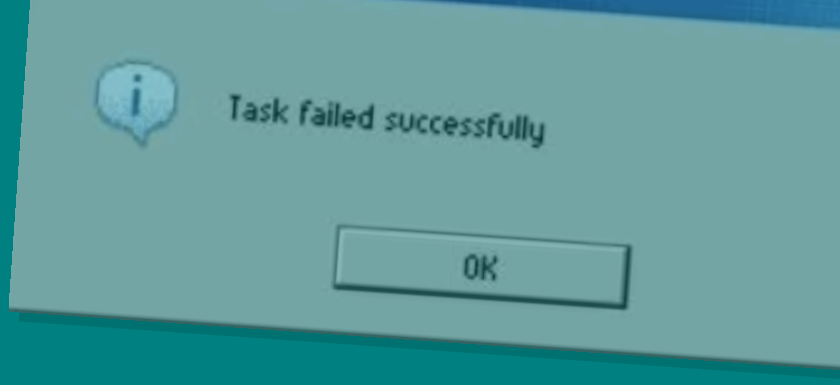
5 **Hidden Discoveries**
Easter eggs, forgotten files, old conversations, unexpected finds

Programs — Accessories



SECTION 03 · PART ONE

Ideas to Get You Started



My Documents



Files & historical events. Fill the drives with documents and images tied to real events of the period, so the machine feels like it belonged to someone.

```
9-11-attack-planning.pdf
world_cup_1998.jpg
without_me_eminem.mp3
```

Internet Explorer — google.com



Websites. Recreate the sites of the era in the exact design and layout they had at the time — search engines, homepages, web rings, guestbooks.

Ideas to Get You Started

C:\Games

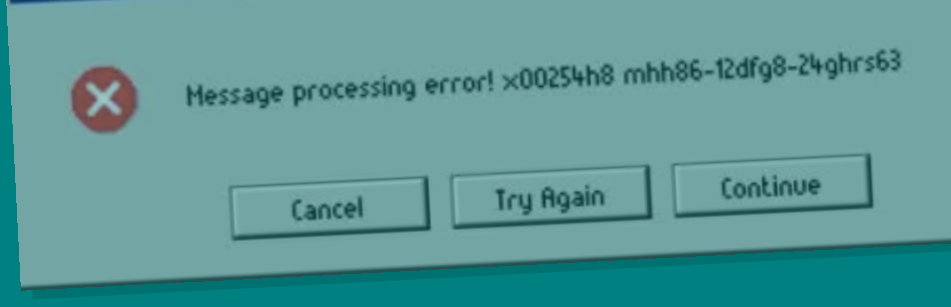


Classic games. Include the games people actually played then — Counter-Strike, GTA III, Minesweeper, Solitaire, Pinball.

My Pictures



Personal memories. Family photographs, vacation pictures, old documents — the things that make a machine feel like it belonged to a real person.



SECTION 04

How You Will Be Judged

01 **Most Important Criteria**
Add Easter eggs and elements that make your presentation during Latent funny, crazy and entertaining for the judges. You make us laugh and we give you points, deal!!

02 **Creativity**
Original ideas and interesting additions to the experience

03 **Functionality**
How interactive and usable the recreated environment is

04 **Visual Authenticity**
How accurately the interface captures the look and feel of Windows 98

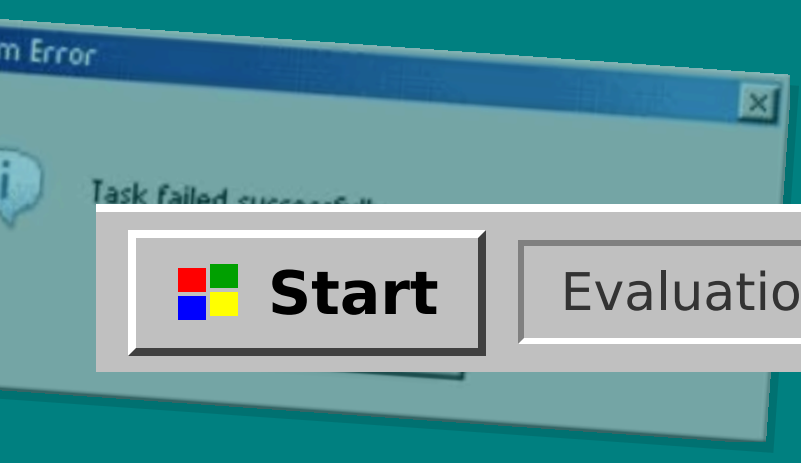
05 **Cleanliness**
Quality of implementation, consistency and overall user experience

Submission required

Every submission must provide **both** of the following:

1. A public GitHub repository — full commit history intact
2. A live working URL a judge can open in a browser

A localhost address, a screen recording or a dead link does not count.



SECTION 05

The Objective

C:\>

Don't just build a website that *looks like* an old computer.

Build an experience that makes someone feel like they have **actually discovered and started using an abandoned computer from 1998**.

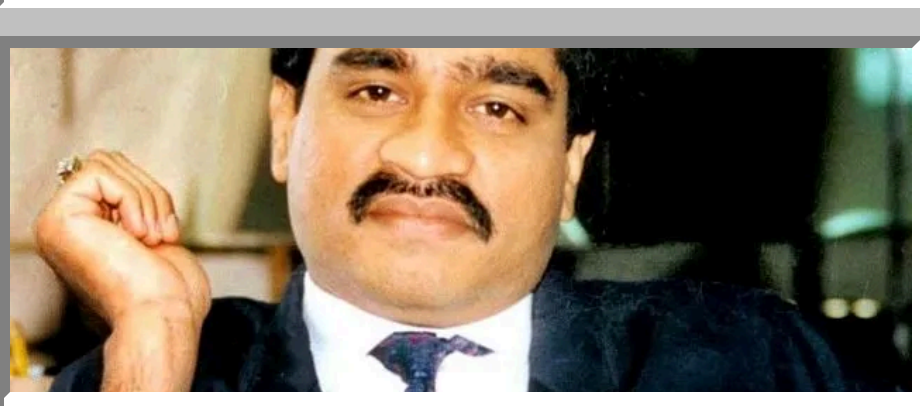
C:\My Documents\1998



titanic_1997.jpg



world_cup_1998.jpg



most_wanted_list.jpg



news_clipping_2001.jpg

`Fill the drives.` The files are what make the machine feel like it belonged to someone.

The machine is yours.
What will you discover?

Gandhi Hackathon · OpenLake × Meraz · IIT Bhilai · 1st November 2026
All announcements go through the official WhatsApp group.

Start | Shut Down... | 7 / 7